

# BITCONNECT

045 / 28 OCT 2017 / BITCONNECT / RARE

## HEY, HEY, HEY!

On 28 October 2017, Carlos Matos took the stage at BitConnect's annual ceremony in Pattaya, Thailand. His exuberant greeting, HEY, HEY, HEY!, became the sound of a crypto meme that outlived the company it celebrated.

BitConnect sold an appealing story: software could turn cryptocurrency trading into dependable returns. Promoters spread that pitch through videos, testimonials and a referral network. The Pattaya ceremony wrapped it in spectacle, recognising leading promoters with cash and luxury cars. A celebration of success doubled as an advertisement for joining in.

Matos later told WNYC that he had invested $25,610. He described being caught up in the event and wanting to tell other people what had happened to him. The speech travelled through remixes, songs and reaction clips. Its confidence made it instantly recognisable, even to people who had never used BitConnect.

BitConnect announced the closure of its lending operation and exchange on 16 January 2018. The later legal record described a Ponzi scheme, in which money from new investors paid earlier ones. U.S. authorities identified Satish Kumbhani as BitConnect's founder. Matos is shown here as the enthusiastic investor and viral speaker, not as the founder or the architect of the scheme.

HISTROVE keeps Matos in the exuberance of 2017, standing on the ground with a microphone and an outstretched hand. Four foreground spectators and falling gold confetti frame a vast illuminated pyramid behind him. The fantasy street and cracked monument are fictional staging, not the real Pattaya venue. The fractures bring hindsight into the celebration; they do not move the later collapse into October 2017.

### DETAILS IN THE ART

**01 THE MICROPHONE**

The microphone, open mouth and outstretched hand recall Matos's exuberant delivery. HEY, HEY, HEY! is a short excerpt verified in WNYC's replay; this pose is an illustration, not an exact frame from the speech.

**02 THE BLANK LANYARD**

A white badge hangs from Matos's neck, but it contains no readable role label. It is an illustrated attendee detail, not an authenticated event pass or evidence that he founded BitConnect.

**03 THE CRACKED PYRAMID**

The broken gold pyramid is a retrospective metaphor for the scheme's failure. It brings knowledge of the later collapse into the illustration; it is not a documented stage prop.

**04 FOUR FOREGROUND SPECTATORS**

Four different foreground figures and falling confetti turn the audience's excitement into a compact celebration. They are fictional spectators, not identified investors, prize winners or a count of the real event's attendance.

### SOURCE & ART NOTE

Sources: Conceptual Events: 28 October 2017 ceremony; WNYC: Matos interview and speech, 2021; SEC complaint, 2021, paras. 71, 81-82, 222; DOJ: BitConnect restitution, 2023. The organiser corroborates the date; WNYC supplies the speech excerpt, not the original full video. The fantasy street, pyramid, spectators and blank badge are illustrative, not a reconstruction of the venue or an authenticated attendee pass. The pyramid is retrospective symbolism; the January 2018 closure is separate. Matos is an investor and viral speaker, not the founder or architect. His investment figure is self-reported; SEC complaint claims remain allegations.